



Utkarsh Kumar Gupta builds an miniature Eiffel tower using laser cut cardboard pieces at Maker's Asylum, Delhi

wide variety in the kind of people that you get exposed to at a makerspace. You can have an aeronautical engineer, an origami artiste and a school kid walk in on the same day. We got some interesting input, but most were simply curious,” explains Valsan.

For participants of the car-build who had also competed the previous year, it was a refreshing break from having to rent out garage space, borrow tools from friends’ dads and call up professors when stuck with a glitch.

So, what is this magical makerspace? Think of it as a library for tools, explains Vaibhav Chhabra, founder of Maker’s Asylum. “Instead of books, we offer access to tools,” he says. It’s a community space which means open access to public that is democratic and not restricted to what you studied in college. In fact, the rules don’t change even if you didn’t go to college at all.

In addition, costs of tools are split by many. Hence, a 3D printer which costs upwards of Rs 1 lakh and laser cutters which will set you back by Rs 3 lakh each are accessible for a nominal usage fee. Moreover, if you are curious to learn something like carpentry but don’t trust yourself to keep at it for too long, investing in tools and materials may not be a wise decision. Think of how you paid for that gym subscription for the whole year only to cool your muscles for the better half of the calendar.

There are more than 20 makerspaces in the country, most of which have been established less than three years ago. Curiosity Gym and Riidl